

157 Make a hidden image

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Want to hide an important map or keep a secret message safe from prying eyes? All you need is a lemon and source of heat to turn yourself into a special agent!

What you need

- Half a lemon • Water
- Bowl • Spoon
- Paintbrush
- White paper • Heat of the Sun or a lamp



1 Squeeze the juice from half a lemon into a bowl. Add several drops of water and use the spoon to mix them thoroughly.



2 Use the paintbrush to make a picture or write a message on the paper. Let it dry—the image should now be invisible.



3 When you want to see the image, hold it up in the hot sun, or next to a lightbulb if it's a cloudy or cold day. The heat from the light will reveal your picture.

Lemon juice turns brown when it's heated. Adding water makes it very hard to see at normal temperatures.

158 Reveal a secret message

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Pick a dandelion and use the sap that oozes out of the stem to write a message on a piece of paper. You won't see the message while it's wet, but just watch what happens as it dries!

Dandelion sap turns brown when it dries

